

KEEPING IT REAL

MOST AGENTS COAST THROUGH Q4. HE DOESN'T.

He calls it separation season. Here's what he does instead.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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BEN LALEZ RUNS A 30-AGENT CHICAGO TEAM DOING SEVERAL HUNDRED MILLION DOLLARS A YEAR. HIS RULE FOR RIGHT NOW: "NOW IS THE TIME WHERE YOU SEPARATE YOURSELF FROM EVERYONE ELSE."

Not because the work shows results yet. Because it won't, for months.

THE FUNDAMENTAL ALMOST NOBODY KEEPS UP IS THE ONE THAT MATTERS MOST.

Ben told me on the show that 85 percent of agents never contact their client again after the sale closes, even though most of those clients will need an agent again in five to ten years. That gap is exactly why Q4 matters: the agents making calls and sending texts with nothing to show for it right now are the ones a past client remembers when they're ready to move again. Ben's own line for it: "Every time you do something that is scary and you complete it, you leave a lot of people behind you."

WHAT TO DO WITH THE REST OF THIS QUARTER:

1 **Run the autopsy.**
Pull your closed deals from this year and write down exactly where each one actually came from, who introduced it and when, not the general category. Patterns show up once you do this slowly, deal by deal.

2 **Extend your business plan by 20 percent.**
If you already hit your numbers, don't ease off. Do 20 percent more of the three or four things on your plan that you know work.

3 **Call one past client you haven't talked to since closing.**
Most agents never do this again. Say it plainly: "I just wanted to check in and see how the house is treating you."

4 **Do the thing that scares you first.**
If picking up the phone is the one you're avoiding, that's the one to do today, not the one to schedule for later.



THE TAKEAWAY

THE AGENTS AHEAD NEXT SPRING DIDN'T WAIT FOR JANUARY TO START.

Separation season is happening right now, whether you show up for it or not.

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